SLEEP 01

Sermorelin

Synthetic 29-amino-acid version of human growth hormone-releasing hormone (GHRH)



CLASS Peptide (GHRH analogue)

STUDIED FOR Growth hormone release

HUMAN EVIDENCE FDA approved 1990–2009 (Geref)

US STATUS Not FDA approved now (Geref withdrawn 2009)

STUDIED FOR

- Pituitary GH test — HUMAN
- Child GH deficiency — HUMAN
- GH in older adults — HUMAN
- Sleep — HUMAN

Sleep and aging use is off-label. No sermorelin trial has measured sleep or lifespan as its result, and no human study of mouth, troche or strip forms was found.

HOW IT WORKS IN THE BODY

Sermorelin ▶ Pituitary gland ▶ Growth hormone ▶ IGF-1

- **Shortest synthetic peptide** with the full activity of GHRH
- **Acts on the pituitary** to release growth hormone (1999 review)
- **In older men,** GH and IGF-1 rose at the higher of two doses (1992)
- **Effects on sleep** in people are not established

EVIDENCE & WHAT'S KNOWN

EVIDENCE

FDA APPROVED
LEVEL 5 OF 5

- FDA approved 1990 and 1997; withdrawn 2009
- Not withdrawn for safety (FDA, 2013)
- No sleep or longevity trial

NOT YET ESTABLISHED

- Long-term safety
- Half-life in people
- Effects on sleep
- Mouth, troche or strip forms

QUICK PRACTICAL INFO

HALF-LIFE Not established

ROUTES STUDIED Injection under the skin (studies); Geref was an injection

PHARMACOKINETICS Limited human data

SOLD AS Compounded (Rx); no FDA-approved product today

MONITORED IN TRIALS GH, IGF-1, glucose, blood pressure (small studies)

SPORT (WADA) Prohibited, class S2

REGULATORY

FDA	Geref approvals withdrawn 2009, not for safety
FDA	503B bulk list, Category 1 (under evaluation)
WADA	Prohibited (S2.2.4)

REFERENCES

1. FDA, Federal Register 78 FR 14095, Geref not withdrawn for safety, Mar 2013
2. J Clin Endocrinol Metab, Corpas et al., GHRH-(1-29) in older men, Aug 1992
3. WADA, 2026 Prohibited List

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